

Round one, Rural R&D for Profit summary of approved projects

On 6 May 2015 the Hon. Barnaby Joyce MP, the Minister for Agriculture, announced funding of \$26.7 million from 2014-15 to 2017-18 for twelve projects in round one of the Rural R&D for Profit Program. This funding was matched by more than \$33 million in cash and in-kind contributions by research and development corporations and their partners. The application period for the first round of funding opened on 15 October 2014, and closed on 15 December 2014.

The successful projects all contribute to the program objective – to realise productivity and profitability improvements for primary producers. All projects have been completed and final reports published.

Project title	Applicant	Grant funding awarded (GST excl)	Applicant/ partner contributions (GST excl.)	Partners	Summary
Smarter irrigation for profit	Cotton Research and Development Corporation	\$4,000,000	\$3,435,000 cash \$2,906,949 in- kind	Dairy Australia Limited; Rural Industries Research Development Corporation (AgriFutures Australia); University of Southern Queensland; Tasmanian Institute for Agriculture; Gwydir Valley Irrigators Association; VIC Department of Economic Development, Jobs, Transport and Resources; NSW Department of Primary Industries; South Australian Research and Development	The project will lead to improved irrigation practices on cotton, rice, sugar and dairy farms. It will help approximately 3000 farmers to optimise their water-use decisions, leading to yield increases and reduced input costs and water use. This project is now completed. A summary of the outcomes, an excerpt from the final report, can be downloaded here.

Stimulating private sector extension in Australian agriculture to increase returns from R&D	Dairy Australia Limited	\$1,595,000	\$810,000 cash \$785,000 in-kind	Institute; Commonwealth Scientific and Industrial Research Organisation; DairyTas; Cotton Australia; Dairy SA; Sugar Research Australia Limited; Sundown Pastoral Company; Auscott; Irrigated Cropping Council; Irrigation Research and Extension Committee Inc.; Southern Growers Inc.	PDF (177 KB) DOCX (76 KB)	The final report can be accessed from the Cotton Research and Development Corporation website .
				Meat and Livestock Australia; University of Melbourne; Cotton Research and Development Corporation; Australian Pork Limited; Sugar Research Australia Limited; Horticulture Innovation Australia Limited; VIC Department of Economic Development, Jobs, Transport and Resources; NSW Department of Primary Industries		The project will research methods of increasing private extension services to primary producers in order to increase producer uptake of new technology and profitability. The project will identify user needs, demand for services and barriers to using these services. Tools and an online portal will be developed to support extension and make sure R&D results are available. The project will build professional

extension capacity in the private sector.

This project is now completed. A summary of the outcomes, an excerpt from the final report, can be downloaded here.

[PDF](#) (185 KB)[DOCX](#) (76 KB)

The final report can be requested by contacting [Dairy Australia](#).

Improved use of seasonal forecasting to increase farmer profitability	Rural Industries Research and Development Corporation (AgriFutures Australia)	\$1,829,249	\$900,974 cash \$829,226 in-kind	Cotton Research and Development Corporation; Grains Research and Development Corporation; Meat and Livestock Australia; Sugar Research Australia Limited; Horticulture Innovation Australia Limited; South Australian Research and Development Institute; WA Department of Agriculture and Food; Australian Bureau of Meteorology; University of Southern Queensland; Birchip Cropping Group; VIC	The project will help farmers make the best of seasonal climate forecasts to maximise their productivity.
					This project is now completed. A summary of the outcomes, an excerpt from the final report, can be downloaded here.
					PDF (179 KB) DOCX (75 KB)
					The final report can be accessed from the AgriFutures Australia website .

Adaptive area-wide management of QFly using SIT: Guidelines for efficient and effective pest suppression and stakeholder adoption					Department of Economic Development, Jobs, Transport and Resources; NSW Department of Primary Industries; Monash University	
						The project will help to control the Queensland Fruit Fly, a major pest of Australian horticulture. It will integrate the release of sterile male flies into area-wide integrated pest management programmes. This will reduce crop losses caused by Queensland fruit fly damage, and will help Australian horticulture industries to access new markets for their products.
						This project is now completed. A summary of the outcomes, an excerpt from the final report, can be downloaded here.
						PDF (174 KB) DOCX (76 KB)

					The final report can be accessed from the Horticulture Innovation Australia Limited website .	
					The project will develop and demonstrate a range of innovative biorefinery technologies that will add value to primary products and by-products. It will develop animal feeds from biomass residues, create chemicals from crops and crop by-products, advanced fuels from agricultural feedstocks, and assess pathways to biorefinery developments in Australia. The project is expected to provide pathways to new markets and reduce input costs for primary producers.	
A profitable future for Australian agriculture: Biorefineries for higher-value animal feeds, chemicals, and fuels	Sugar Research Australia Limited	\$3,090,564	\$1,545,282 cash \$1,544,030 in-kind	Forest and Wood Products Australia; Cotton Research and Development Corporation; Australian Pork Limited; Queensland University of Technology; Southern Oil Refining; NSW Department of Primary Industries; Agrifuels Ltd	This project is now completed. A summary of the outcomes, an	

excerpt from the final report, can be downloaded here.

[PDF](#) (194 KB)[DOCX](#) (77 KB)

The final report can be accessed from the [Sugar Research Australia Ltd website](#).

The project will integrate the latest imaging and robotics technologies to provide mango, avocado and macadamia farmers with decision-support tools to help improve production and profit. The data collected through this project, and the tools it develops, will help farmers to predict fruit quality and yield, and to monitor tree health including early detection of pests and disease outbreaks.

This project is now completed. A summary of the

Multi-scale monitoring tools for managing Australian tree crops – Industry meets innovation

Horticulture Innovation Australia Limited

\$3,428,248

\$1,890,000 cash

\$1,538,248 in-kind

University of Queensland; University of Central Queensland; University of New England; University of Sydney; Avocados Australia; Simpson Farms; Australian Mango Industry Association; Australian Macadamia Society; QLD Department of Agriculture and Fisheries; AGTRIX Ltd

outcomes, an excerpt from the final report, can be downloaded here.

[PDF](#) (177 KB)[DOCX](#) (76 KB)

The final report can be accessed from the [Horticulture Innovation Australia website](#).

Fast-tracking and maximising the long-lasting benefits of weed biological control for farm productivity	Meat and Livestock Australia Limited	\$1,897,918	\$948,959 cash \$948,959 in-kind	Commonwealth Scientific and Industrial Research Organisation; NSW Department of Primary Industries; SA Department of Primary Industries and Regions; QLD Department of Agriculture and Fisheries; VIC Department of Economic Development, Jobs, Transport and Resources; TasWeed Biocontrol; Murdoch University; NSW Local Land Service - Murray; Victoria Gorse Taskforce and Landcare Groups; Pilbara Mesquite Management Committee; South Australian Grains Industry Trust Fund; SA Government	The project will improve the control of six national priority agricultural weeds (parkinsonia, parthenium, blackberry, silverleaf nightshade, cylindropuntia, gorse). Success will be achieved by fast-tracking delivery of eight biocontrol agents to producers and is expected to reduce weed competition and herbicide use. This project is now completed. A summary of the outcomes, an excerpt from the final report, can be downloaded here.
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				PDF (200 KB) DOCX (78 KB)	
				Adelaide and Mount Loft Ranges Natural Resources Management Board;	The final report can be accessed from the Meat & Livestock Australia website. The project aims to develop more cost effective Yellowtail Kingfish feeds and feeding strategies. This will drive immediate production gains for Yellowtail Kingfish aquaculture. An additional focus is to build a Yellowtail Kingfish aquaculture R&D network to strengthen adoption of research outcomes. This project is now completed. A summary of the outcomes, an excerpt from the final report, can be downloaded here.
Growing a profitable, innovative and collaborative Australian Yellowtail Kingfish aquaculture industry: bringing 'white' fish to the market	Fisheries Research and Development Corporation	\$3,000,000	\$1,650,000 cash \$1,400,000 in-kind	South Australian Research and Development Institute; Clean Seas Tuna Ltd; NSW Department of Primary Industries	PDF (206 KB) DOCX (79 KB)
				The final report will be made available by the	

Fisheries Research and Development Corporation in early 2021.

The project will find ways to turn agricultural waste into feed, fertilisers and soil conditioners. This recycling can reduce on-farm input costs, enhance sustainability and provide producers with new opportunities to generate income from waste.

This project is now completed. A summary of the outcomes, an excerpt from the final report, can be downloaded here.

[PDF](#) (201 KB)[DOCX](#) (76 KB)

The final report can be accessed from the [Meat & Livestock Australia website](#).

Waste to revenue: novel fertilisers and feeds

Australian Pork Limited

\$862,693

\$652,376 cash
\$569,000 in-kind

Dairy Australia Limited; Sugar Research Australia Limited; Rural Industries Research and Development Corporation (AgriFutures Australia); Meat and Livestock Australia; University of Queensland; University of Western Australia

Market and Consumer Insights to Drive Food Value Chain

Meat and Livestock Australia

\$2,873,500

\$3,590,000 cash
\$2,382,505 in-kind

VIC Department of Economic Development, Jobs, Transport and Resources;

The project will identify opportunities in export markets and

Innovation and Growth				Horticulture Innovation Australia Limited; Commonwealth Scientific and Industrial Research Organisation; Australian Seafood Cooperative Research Centre; Fisheries Research and Development Corporation	help producers and their supply chain partners respond effectively to those opportunities to grow their businesses. It aims to build the capacity of agri-food supply chains to innovate and collaborate for market advantage by creating easy-to-access tools and strategies, including online resources and face-to-face workshops. This project is now completed. A summary of the outcomes, an excerpt from the final report, can be downloaded here. PDF (164 KB)DOCX (75 KB) The final report can be accessed from the Meat & Livestock Australia website.
	MIR for profit: integrating very large genomic and milk mid-infrared data to improve	Dairy Australia Limited	\$927,273	\$518,182 cash \$510,000 in-kind	VIC Department of Economic Development, Jobs, Transport and Resources; National Herd Improvement Association; The project will develop new tools to help dairy farmers manage and select the most profitable cows by

						using technology to scan milk samples for genetic, health and production information. The outcomes would then inform breeding decisions to improve the genetics gain of the national herd.
profitability of dairy cows				DataGene; Teagasc; University of Liege; Walloon Agricultural Research Centre		This project is now completed. A summary of the outcomes, an excerpt from the final report, can be downloaded here. PDF (185 KB)DOCX (76 KB) The final report can be requested by contacting Dairy Australia
Consolidating targeted and practical extension services for Australian Farmers and Fishers (The foundation to address Priority 4a)	Rural Industries Research and Development Corporation (AgriFutures Australia)	\$815,000	\$815,000 cash \$600,000 in-kind	VIC Department of Economic Development, Jobs, Transport and Resources; Tasmanian Institute of Agriculture; NT Department of Primary Industries and Fisheries; NSW Local Land Services; University of Melbourne		The project will provide Australian agricultural extension services with greater national coordination and leadership. Fragmentation of extension activities may be one of the causal factors for recent declines in productivity and profitability growth

in Australian agriculture. By addressing this problem, greater productivity gains can be realised.

This project is now completed. A summary of the outcomes, an excerpt from the final report, can be downloaded here.

[PDF](#) (182 KB)[DOCX](#) (76 KB)

The final report can be accessed from the [AgriFutures Australia website](#).

		\$17,930,773
		cash
		\$15,188,917 in-
Totals	\$26,669,445	kind
		\$33,119,690
		total

Source: <https://www.agriculture.gov.au/agriculture-land/farm-food-drought/innovation/rural-research-development-for-profit/approved-projects>